THE NEXT 100 ENTREPRENEURS

QUEEN OF WORKWEAR

AYUSHI GUDWANI, 37

Founder and CEO, FableStreet
Gurugram



CHANDRADEEP KUMAR

When Gudwani began working as a management consultant at McKinsey, the first thing she noticed was the paucity of professional-wear options for women. Most brands in this field were international, with the clothing not specifically designed for Indian women. Spying an opportunity, she set up FableStreet, a domestic clothing brand catering specifically to India's professional women, in 2016. . Gudwani says that though she has a personal interest in such products, she was clear that her firm would not be a passion play but rather would be established on a sound business model. She says her company's revenue has grown eightfold in the past two years, all the more impressive given that this took place during the pandemic. "Short of sewing, I can do and know everything about the garment business," she says. She has so far successfully conducted two rounds of funding, raising about $500,000 (Rs 3.8 crore) in seed funding and close to $3 million (Rs 22 crore) from Fireside Ventures. She says her goal is to have a store in every Indian metro once the pandemic has receded. ■

–Shwweta Punj

FUN AND GAMES Gudwani plays badminton on the weekends, and her favourite exercise is weighted squats

> "Entrepreneurship is a hard journey, and always will be. It comes with the need to do everything from scratch"